

A *function* is a block of code that you can name and that performs a certain task. You can run the block many times by using the function name. The *definition* of a function specifies its name and the data the function needs to work. *Parameters* are the variables in the function that hold this data.

To use a function, you *call* it. When you call a function, you must provide values, or *arguments*, for each of the function's parameters.

Functions allow you to write code efficiently. When you need to perform an action more than once, wrap that code in a function and call it when you need it. When you need to change how the action is carried out, you can change the code in the function, and the improvement is applied everywhere.